Board update · Q2 2026

Meridian Freight

The quarter beat plan, but a carrier-capacity squeeze needs a board decision today.

We beat plan on revenue and margin — and we need your call on capacity by Friday.

Bottom line up front: Q2 revenue landed 11% ahead of plan and contribution margin expanded for the third straight quarter. The one open question is carrier capacity for peak season, and it requires board approval this week.

- Strong quarter, clean balance sheet, no surprises in the numbers.
- One time-boxed decision: pre-buy capacity now, or risk Q4 service levels.

Revenue, margin, and cash all came in ahead of plan.

$58.4M

Quarterly revenue

PLAN $52.6M · +11% ✓ AHEAD BOARD

31%

Contribution margin

+3PP QOQ ✓ AHEAD AUDIT

$41M

Cash & equivalents

+$6M QOQ ✓ ON PLAN INVESTOR

Demand · Q2 2026

Growth was broad — every region and lane category pulled its weight.

Measured against Q2 2025, same lane mix, normalized for fuel surcharge.

+18%	2,310	96.2%	−7%
SHIPMENTS YOY	ACTIVE SHIPPERS	ON-TIME DELIVERY	COST PER LOAD

Demand is outrunning the carrier capacity we have contracted.

Volume is up 18% year over year, but our committed carrier capacity grew only 9%. Through Q2 we covered the gap on the spot market — fine in a soft rate environment, but peak season changes that math.

- Spot exposure was 14% of loads in Q2, up from 6% a year ago.
- Spot rates historically spike 30–40% from October through December.

The exposure we are carrying into peak

$4.2M

of incremental Q4 cost if we cover peak demand on the spot market at last year's rate curve.

A capacity pre-buy locks rates now, before the peak-season run-up.

Carriers will commit Q4 capacity at today's rates in exchange for a guaranteed minimum. Signing in June secures the lanes we need at roughly 22% below the spot curve we'd otherwise pay in Q4.

- The commitment is $9.8M of guaranteed spend across four core carriers.
- Break-even holds even if peak volume comes in 15% below forecast.

The pre-buy is the only option that protects both service and margin.

Protects service · Hurts margin.

Cover peak entirely on the spot market

Hurts service · Hurts margin.

Cap volume to contracted capacity, turn away demand

Hurts service · Protects margin.

Defer the decision to Q3 and renegotiate

Protects service · Protects margin.

Pre-buy Q4 capacity now at locked rates

Pre-buy economics · Q4 2026

The pre-buy pays for itself even in a soft-demand scenario.

$9.8M
COMMITTED SPEND

−22%
VS SPOT CURVE

$2.6M
PROJECTED SAVINGS

1.4×
DOWNSIDE COVERAGE

Full-year guidance holds, with upside if peak demand lands as forecast.

$238M

FY revenue guide

REAFFIRMED · ✓ ON PLAN · BOARD

30%

FY contribution margin

+2PP VS FY25 · ✓ ON PLAN · AUDIT

99%

peak coverage with pre-buy

VS 86% WITHOUT · ✓ DECISION · OPS

We ask the board to approve a $9.8M Q4 capacity pre-buy this week.

APPROVE THE PRE-BUY

Locks peak rates 22% below spot and protects our 96% on-time record.

DEFER TO Q3

Cedes the rate window; exposes Q4 to a projected $4.2M spot premium.

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Strong quarter — let's protect the peak.